

PUSHKARNA PRAMOD

Nuclear Prowess

From being denied technology To self-reliance

By conducting the successful nuclear tests of Pokhran-1 in May 1974 and Pokhran-2 in May 1998, India boldly showcased its self-reliance in nuclear weapons development. The Indian tests changed the nature of the international non-proliferation game as well as the structure of international security. The Nuclear Suppliers Group severely affected India's nuclear programme, with the world's major nuclear powers imposing a technological embargo. But this denial helped develop our self-reliant capability in atomic energy in power and non-power applications, nuclear submarine, and both fission and fusion/ thermonuclear-based weapons.

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India Stack

Digital India among global frontrunners

India Stack positioned Indians as the trailblazers of the Internet age by promoting financial and social inclusion across the country. The foundation for this digital transformation was laid by the Aadhaar card that provided identity to 1.3 billion Indians by enabling quick identification of the user digitally, anywhere, anytime. In 2016, the second arm of India Stack was born with the announcement of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) that catapulted the entire nation into the era of digital payments just by scanning a QR code. Within just six years, it has become the world's fifth largest payment network by volume, surpassing over 20 billion online transactions during the second quarter of 2022.